



Ajay Sawhney, secretary, MeitY, addressing the audience at ELCINA-EFY Awards 2016-17

As always, this year too, awards were distributed across several different categories, including special jury awards. The categories were: exports, quality, environmental management, R&D, excellence in innovation, business excellence, entrepreneurial excellence, and the special jury awards.

On the Electronics Policy 2.0, Sawhney talked about his past experiences, saying that he had been worried about the electronics industry when he joined MeitY, wondering back then what could be done to encourage manufacturing. So he will soon come back with a policy and strategy for the industry.

"We have seen a reduction of imports in at least a few segments and an increase in exports for at least five or six major segments," said Sawhney. He requested the industry for its insights and feedback, to understand what is going on in these segments, what policies are working and what are not, and where the government could help to make a bigger impact.

Sawhney added that if the industry has any concerns or advice regarding the National Policy on Electronics, the government is willing to take a relook at it. He requested active participation from stakeholders to add value to the policy, and to make it better and more powerful.

As the event progressed with eminent speakers getting an apt platform to express their views candidly, Ramesh Chopra, executive chairman, EFY Group and founder editor, *Electronics For You*, spoke proudly about the ELCINA-EFY association that went back almost five decades.

Expressing his gratitude, he said EFY and ELCINA are fortunate to have such a dynamic association. Rewinding to ELCINA's beginning, Chopra said, "It started as an electronic component manufacturers' association and now it is representing the entire electronics industry in India, especially the hardware sector."

He then elaborated on the journey, saying that ELCINA had been with the industry through thick and

thin, ups and downs and always conveyed the views of the industry to the government, from time to time. He said that EFY considers itself fortunate to have partnered with ELCINA to present the ELCINA-EFY Awards from 2010 onwards.

Before 2010, ELCINA had presented these awards on its own, while EFY had been presenting the Readers' Choice awards, which were later discontinued. "There is no doubt in my mind that the industry could not have survived without ELCINA for such a long time. I salute all the present and past presidents, as well as the office bearers who have kept the industry motivated all along. I also want to salute all those who have remained with the industry through troubled times," said Chopra.

As the event progressed, the captains of the industry discussed the government's role in the electronics industry. Vikram Desai, managing director, Desai Electronics, said, "Based on the views expressed here, we are truly convinced that the government does recognise and appreciate the concerns of the industry. The government is more than willing to support the Indian electronics industry and formulate a policy which is pro-industry, and promote the growth of the industry. It has also clearly expressed that the electronics industry has already experienced its worst phase and it's high time that this should change. The future is very promising and bright. We all look forward to the roll-out of the revised national electronics policy — Electronics Policy 2.0 — which will mark the beginning of a new era in the electronics manufacturing sector."

Sharing his thoughts on the expansion of the electronics industry, Vinod Sharma, managing director, Deki Electronics, who also won the 'Electronics Man of the Year' award, said, "I want to contribute whatever I can back to the industry and to policy making. As an industry, we should make ourselves so strong that we do not sell only in India but are also able to sell globally. Because, I think we have the brains to succeed." **EFY**